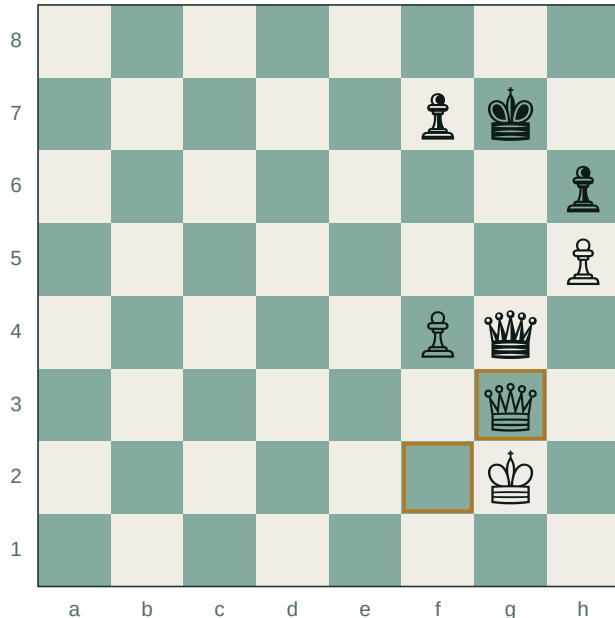


Active defensive resources: Black, move 55

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 55.Qg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55...Qxg3+ 56. Kxg3 Kf6 57. Kg4 Ke6

55...Qxg3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g3. Recorded reply: **56.Kxg3**.

56...Kf6 The king moves from g7 to f6. Recorded reply: **57.Kg4**.

57...Ke6 The king moves from f6 to e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g2. Absolute pin: queen on g3.